

09

Access and Permission Requests

Shared drives, application roles, groups, distribution lists and access removal

Default priority: P4 Low (P3 if tied to a deadline)

Target response / resolution: Respond in 30 min / fulfil in 1 business day after approval

Handled by: Tier 1 / Tier 2

Scope

Use this instruction when a user asks for access to a folder, application, group, or system, or reports "Access denied".

Related instructions: WI-17 Offboarding, WI-02 Onboarding, WI-10 Security Incidents

Common symptoms

- "You do not have permission" when opening a file, site, or application
- New role or project needs additional access
- User needs to be added to or removed from a group or list

Information to collect

- Exact resource (path, URL, application, or group name)
- Access level needed: read, edit, or admin
- Business reason and the duration (permanent or temporary)
- Requester's manager and the data owner

Resolution steps

- 1 Confirm the requester.** Check that the request comes from the user or their manager through the ticket portal, and that the user is an active employee.
- 2 Identify the owner.** Find the data or application owner in the access register. Access must be approved by the owner, not only by the user's manager.
- 3 Obtain approval.** Send the approval request to the owner and record the approval in the ticket. Do not grant access on verbal approval alone.
- 4 Apply least privilege.** Grant only the level requested, using a group where possible rather than direct assignment. Set an expiry date for temporary access.
- 5 Check for conflicts.** For finance, HR, and other sensitive systems, check segregation-of-duties rules and escalate to the application owner if there is a conflict.
- 6 Confirm access.** Ask the user to sign out and in again, then open the resource. Allow time for group membership changes to replicate.
- 7 Record the change.** Note who approved, what was granted, and any expiry date, so the access can be reviewed later.

Escalate when

- Requests for administrator or privileged rights
- Owner cannot be identified or does not respond within the approval window
- User claims to have lost access that was never recorded as granted

Resolution and closure

- Attach the approval and record the group or role changes
- Set a reminder to remove temporary access
- Close after the user confirms they can reach the resource

Quick troubleshooting reference

Symptom	Likely cause	What to do
"Access denied" on a shared folder	User not in the access group	Find the owner, get approval, and add the user to the group.
User cannot see an application	Role or licence not assigned	Check the role mapping and licence, then ask the application owner to assign.
Access still denied after approval	Group change not yet replicated	Ask the user to sign out and in, and wait for replication.
Request needs admin rights	Privileged access request	Escalate to the owner and Security for approval and a time limit.
Former colleague still has access	Offboarding step missed	Remove access now, log a security note, and review the offboarding record.

Suggested wording for the user

Open	<i>"What exactly are you trying to open, and what level of access do you need: view, edit, or manage?"</i>
During	<i>"The owner of that folder needs to approve this. I have sent the request and will update you when they reply."</i>
Close	<i>"Access is in place. Please sign out and back in. Tell me if you still see an error."</i>

Good practice

Do

- Get approval from the data owner
- Grant least privilege
- Use groups, not direct permissions
- Set expiry dates for temporary access

Do not

- Do not grant access on verbal approval
- Do not copy permissions from another user
- Do not grant admin rights without a documented need
- Do not forget to record what was granted

Worked example

A new project member needs edit access to a finance folder.

Ticket note field	Entry
Issue reported	Needs edit access to the budget folder for a project ending in June.
Checks performed	Folder owner is the Finance Manager. Segregation-of-duties check passed.
Cause	New project role.
Action taken	Approval received. User added to the edit group with an expiry date.
Result	Access confirmed. Reminder set to remove access in June.

Analyst checklist

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| ☐ Confirm the requester | ☐ Confirm access |
| ☐ Identify the owner | ☐ Record the change |
| ☐ Obtain approval | ☐ Ticket note completed using the standard template |
| ☐ Apply least privilege | ☐ User confirmed the issue is resolved |
| ☐ Check for conflicts | |

Preventing repeat tickets

- Run quarterly access reviews
- Keep the access register current
- Use role-based groups
- Automate removal on role change